BANG FOR YOUR DUCK

Ponoka—Didsbury

Blaine Calkins · Conservative · AB

40 / 100

COMPOSITE SCORE

Bang for Your Duck: D · 48/100

Value for federal tax dollars flowing into this riding

Report generated October 24, 2026

Sources: Elections Canada · OpenParliament.ca · Infrastructure Canada · Open Canada Grants & Contributions · House of Commons · StatsCan 2021

Governments publish the data. We collect it, score it, and present it in one place.

About This Report

Editorial Disclaimer

Bang for Your Duck is an independent, nonpartisan editorial project. Scores and grades represent opinions based on publicly available government data. This report is not legal, financial, or political advice. We are not affiliated with any political party, government body, or lobby group.

How We Grade

This report grades your riding — not your MP personally — on measurable dollar flows: federal investment received (50%), federal transfers allocated (35%), and the cost of representation (15%). Context categories like MP Work, Electoral Health, and Demographics are shown but do not factor into the composite grade.

What We Don't Measure

No model captures the full picture of parliamentary representation. Constituency casework, committee influence, speech quality, legislative amendments, caucus advocacy, and riding-level service delivery are important but not quantifiable from publicly available data at scale. Our scores are a starting point for conversation, not the final word.

Structural Factors

Scores are affected by factors outside any MP's direct control: geography (travel costs are higher for remote ridings), government vs. opposition status (governing MPs have more influence over spending), provincial transfer formulas (all ridings in a province share the same transfer score), population density, and urban vs. rural characteristics. A low score reflects federal spending patterns, not an MP's dedication.

For MPs and Staff

We grade ridings, not individuals. If any data in this report is inaccurate, we want to know. Email corrections@bangforyourduck.ca with the riding name, the data point in question, the correct figure, and supporting documentation. We review all correction requests and will update scores if warranted.

Data Sources

- Infrastructure Canada Open Data (infrastructure.gc.ca)
- Open Canada Grants & Contributions (open.canada.ca)
- OpenParliament.ca — Session 45-1
- Elections Canada — 45th General Election
- House of Commons Proactive Disclosure (ourcommons.ca)
- Statistics Canada — 2021 Census of Population
- Department of Finance — Major Federal Transfers 2023-24

Full methodology: bangforyourduck.ca/methodology

Score Breakdown

Ponoka—Didsbury · Blaine Calkins

Federal Investment

Weight: 50%

F · 30/100 — 30

Federal Transfers

Weight: 35%

F · 10/100 — 10

Total: $1633/person · CHT: $1155 · No equalization

MP Expenses

Weight: 15%

D · 52/100 — 52

MP Performance

Weight: Context

B+ · 77/100 — 77

Votes: 100% · Bills: 8 · Speeches: 500 · (+5 opposition bonus)

Electoral Health

Weight: Context

D · 52/100 — 52

Turnout: 64.7% · Margin: 32.5% · Candidates: 6

Demographics

Weight: Context

D · 55/100 — 55

Income: $100,200 · Unemployment: 4.7% · Post-secondary: 61%

Grade Calculation: (30 x 0.50) + (10 x 0.35) + (52 x 0.15) = 15 + 4 + 8 = 40/100

Grade = dollars flowing into your riding vs the cost of representation. Performance, electoral, and demographics are shown as context only.

How Your MP Voted

Blaine Calkins · 94 of 94 votes attended · 100% participation

Vote numbers are clickable — click any # to view the full vote on OpenParliament.ca

#	DATE	BILL	DESCRIPTION	RESULT	VOTE
94	03-26	—	Eighth report of the Standing Committee on	Tie	Yes
93	03-25	C-9	3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-9, An A	Passed	No
92	03-25	C-9	Bill C-9, An Act to amend the Criminal Cod	Failed	Yes
91	03-25	C-242	2nd reading of Bill C-242, An Act to amend	Failed	Yes
90	03-25	C-243	2nd reading of Bill C-243, An Act to amend	Failed	Yes
89	03-25	C-220	2nd reading of Bill C-220, An Act to amend	Failed	Yes
88	03-25	C-246	2nd reading of Bill C-246, An Act to amend	Failed	Yes
87	03-24	—	Opposition Motion (Tariff-free auto pact)	Failed	Yes
86	03-23	C-9	Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-9, A	Passed	No
85	03-11	C-233	2nd reading of Bill C-233, An Act to amend	Failed	No
84	03-10	—	Government Business No. 6 (Proceedings on	Passed	No
83	03-10	—	Motion for closure	Passed	No
82	02-25	C-15	Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-15,	Passed	No
81	02-25	C-15	Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro	Failed	No
80	02-25	C-15	Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro	Failed	Yes
79	02-25	C-15	Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro	Failed	No
78	02-25	C-15	Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro	Failed	Yes
77	02-25	C-15	Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro	Failed	Yes
76	02-25	C-15	Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro	Failed	No
75	02-25	C-15	Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro	Failed	No
74	02-25	C-237	2nd reading of Bill C-237, An Act to amend	Failed	Yes
73	02-25	C-244	2nd reading of Bill C-244, An Act to amend	Passed	No
72	02-25	—	Opposition Motion (Federal benefits and as	Failed	Yes
71	02-23	—	Opposition Motion (Automotive strategy)	Failed	Yes
70	02-23	—	Opposition Motion (Automotive strategy) (	Failed	Yes
69	02-12	S-210	2nd reading of Bill S-210, An Act respecti	Passed	Yes
68	02-12	C-227	2nd reading of Bill C-227, An Act to estab	Passed	No
67	02-12	—	Opposition Motion (Serious crimes and refu	Failed	Yes
66	02-09	—	Opposition Motion (Apology to those whose	Passed	Yes
65	02-04	C-245	2nd reading of Bill C-245, An Act to amend	Failed	No
64	02-04	C-222	2nd reading of Bill C-222, An Act to amend	Passed	Yes
63	02-04	—	Opposition Motion (Food affordability)	Failed	Yes
62	02-02	C-18	2nd reading of Bill C-18, An Act to implem	Passed	Yes
61	01-28	C-228	2nd reading of Bill C-228, An Act to amend	Failed	No
60	01-28	—	Opposition Motion (Canadian economic sover	Failed	Yes
59	12-11	C-12	Bill C-12, An Act respecting certain measu	Passed	Yes
58	12-11	C-12	Bill C-12, An Act respecting certain measu	Passed	Yes
57	12-11	C-12	Bill C-12, An Act respecting certain measu	Failed	No
56	12-11	C-12	Bill C-12, An Act respecting certain measu	Failed	Yes
55	12-09	—	Opposition Motion (Pipeline construction)	Failed	Yes

How Your MP Voted (continued)

#	DATE	BILL	DESCRIPTION	RESULT	VOTE
54	12-09	—	Opposition Motion (Pipeline construction)	Failed	Yes
53	12-08	C-15	2nd reading of Bill C-15, An Act to implem	Failed	Yes
52	12-03	C-241	2nd reading of Bill C-241, An Act to estab	Passed	Yes
51	12-03	C-225	2nd reading of Bill C-225, An Act to amend	Passed	Yes
50	11-17	—	Budgetary policy	Passed	No
49	11-07	—	Budgetary policy (amendment)	Failed	No
48	11-06	—	Budgetary policy (subamendment)	Failed	Yes
47	11-05	C-3	3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-3, An A	Passed	No
46	11-04	—	First report of the Standing Committee on	Passed	Yes
45	11-03	C-3	Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-3, A	Passed	No
44	11-03	C-3	Bill C-3, An Act to amend the Citizenship	Passed	No
43	10-28	—	Third report of the Standing Committee on	Passed	Yes
42	10-28	—	Third report of the Standing Committee on	Passed	Yes
41	10-20	—	Opposition Motion (Cost of deficits)	Failed	Yes
40	10-06	—	Opposition Motion (Passage of Bill C-242)	Failed	Yes
39	10-01	—	Opposition Motion (Food taxation)	Failed	Yes
38	09-24	—	Opposition Motion (Constitutional powers o	Failed	Yes
37	09-23	—	Opposition Motion (Oil and gas emissions c	Failed	Yes
36	09-22	C-3	2nd reading of Bill C-3, An Act to amend t	Passed	No
35	09-22	—	Opposition Motion (Violent crime and repea	Failed	Yes
34	06-20	C-5	3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-5, An A	Passed	Yes
33	06-20	C-5	3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-5, An A	Passed	Yes
32	06-20	C-5	Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-5, A	Passed	Yes
31	06-20	C-5	Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a	Failed	No
30	06-20	C-5	Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a	Passed	Yes
29	06-20	C-5	Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a	Failed	Yes
28	06-20	C-5	Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a	Failed	No
27	06-20	C-5	Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a	Passed	Yes
26	06-20	C-5	Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a	Passed	Yes
25	06-20	C-5	Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a	Passed	Yes
24	06-20	C-5	Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a	Failed	Yes
23	06-20	C-5	Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a	Failed	No
22	06-17	C-7	3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-7, An A	Passed	No
21	06-17	C-7	Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-7, A	Passed	No
20	06-17	C-7	2nd reading of Bill C-7, An Act for granti	Passed	No
19	06-17	—	Concurrence in estimates (Supplementary Es	Passed	No
18	06-17	C-6	3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-6, An A	Passed	No
17	06-17	C-6	Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-6, A	Passed	No
16	06-17	C-6	2nd reading of Bill C-6, An Act for granti	Passed	No
15	06-17	—	Concurrence in estimates (Main Estimates f	Passed	No
14	06-17	—	Opposition Motion (Sale of gas-powered veh	Failed	Yes
13	06-16	C-5	2nd reading of Bill C-5, An Act to enact t	Passed	Yes
12	06-16	—	Government Business No. 1 (Proceedings on	Passed	Yes

How Your MP Voted (continued)

#	DATE	BILL	DESCRIPTION	RESULT	VOTE
11	06-16	—	Government Business No. 1 (Proceedings on	Failed	No
10	06-16	—	Opposition Motion (GCStrategies Inc.)	Passed	Yes
9	06-16	—	Motion for closure	Passed	Yes
8	06-12	C-4	2nd reading of Bill C-4, An Act respecting	Passed	Yes
7	06-11	—	Opposition Motion (Canada carbon rebate an	Failed	No
6	06-11	—	Opposition Motion (Canada carbon rebate an	Failed	No
5	06-10	—	Opposition Motion (Food inflation and budg	Failed	Yes
4	06-05	—	Ways and means motion No. 1	Passed	Yes
3	06-02	—	Address in Reply to the Speech from the Th	Passed	Yes
2	06-02	—	Address in Reply to the Speech from the Th	Passed	Yes
1	05-29	—	Address in Reply to the Speech from the Th	Passed	Yes

Source: OpenParliament.ca · Session 45-1 · All 94 recorded votes

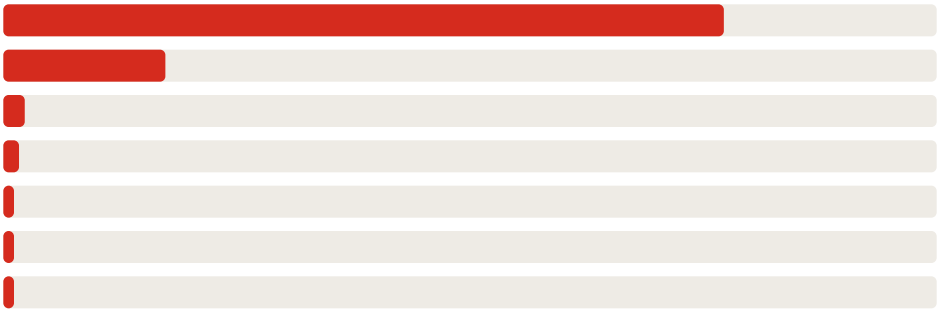
Verify votes on OpenParliament.ca !'

Federal Spending in Your Riding

$10.9M total federal investment

Ranked #312 of 340 ridings by per-capita investment | Infrastructure Canada

Spending by Category



Highways and Roads	$8.4M (77%)
Wastewater	$1.9M (17%)
Ventilation	$0.3M (2%)
Active Transportation	$0.2M (2%)
Broadband And Connectivity	$0.1M (1%)
Capacity Building	$0.1M (0%)
Drinking Water	$0.1M (0%)

Largest Projects

PROJECT	FEDERAL $	CATEGORY
Pavement Rehabilitation Projects - Southern Alberta (20 Recipient: Alberta Ministry of Transportation	$3.5M	Highways and Roads
North Industrial Area - Road Work & Storm Water Managem Recipient: Didsbury, Town of	$1.8M	Wastewater
Highway 2 Bundle Recipient: Alberta Ministry of Transportation	$1.7M	Highways and Roads
County of Ponoka Meniak Road Recipient: Ponoka, County of	$1.5M	Highways and Roads
50 Street Rehabilitation - Town of Ponoka Recipient: Ponoka, Town of	$0.8M	Highways and Roads
Resurfacing Highway 2 Recipient: Alberta, Government of	$0.5M	Highways and Roads

+ 4 more projects

Source: Infrastructure Canada Open Data · Open Canada Grants & Contributions

View Infrastructure Canada project map !'

MP Expense Report

Calkins, Blaine · House of Commons Proactive Disclosure

Current Quarter (Q3 2025-26)

Staff Salaries	**$95,553**	55% of total
Travel	**$60,002**	35% of total
Hospitality	**$1,473**	1% of total
Contracts	**$16,048**	9% of total

Q3 Total: $173,076

Annualized estimate: ~$692,304

Source: House of Commons Proactive Disclosure · ourcommons.ca

View Q3 2025-26 MP expenses on ourcommons.ca !'

How You Compare

National rank: #220 of 340
Provincial rank (AB): #17 of 37

Comparable Ridings

RIDING	MP	PARTY	GRADE	SCORE
Ponoka—Didsbury	**Blaine Calkins**	**Conservative**	**D**	**40**
Airdrie—Cochrane	Blake Richards	Conservative	D	40
Calgary Skyview	Amanpreet Gill	Conservative	D	43
Edmonton Centre	Eleanor Olszewski	Liberal	D	46
Medicine Hat—Cardston—Warner	Glen Motz	Conservative	D	46
Red Deer	Burton Bailey	Conservative	D	47

Questions to Ask Your MP

- What federal infrastructure grants has this riding received in the past 3 years, and how does that compare to similar ridings?
- Voter turnout in this riding was 64.7%. What are you doing to encourage democratic participation?
- This province does not receive equalization payments. How are you ensuring federal investment still flows back to our community?
- What is your top priority for this riding in the next parliamentary session, and how will you measure success?

MP or staff? Help us improve accuracy.

If any data in this report is inaccurate, visit bangforyourduck.ca/methodology or email corrections@bangforyourduck.ca with the riding name, the data point in question, and supporting documentation.